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AMBIDEXTROUS KEYHOLE-ACCESS POCKET

Abstract

Many garments lack pockets, and/or have pocket openings which may: be accessible to only right hand or left exclusively, require both hands to open the pocket closure, gape open, allowing items to exit the pocket without the wearer intending this. An extra pocket or a plurality of pockets offering both security and easy access is a welcome amenity. Disclosed is the reversible ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket, first embodiment as an integral part of a scarf having one or more such pockets, as well as a new method of suspending and accessing said pocket. Practical and elegantly simple but also unique, novel, surprising and unexpected, the combination of a particular style of keyhole and pocket, transforms the utility and convenience of pockets, improving articles into which said pockets are made.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a Non-Provisional Continuation Patent Application claiming priority under 35 U.S.C § 119 (e) to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/262,751 filed on Oct. 20, 2021, and U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/969,079, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0002] The present disclosure is generally related of reversible scarfs and other accessories, and further is related to several fields and industries, including the fiber arts, the fabric industry, the yarn industry, and the garment industry.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0003] The utility of many garment pockets is limited because they can be accessed by only one hand or the other. Many scarf pockets with closures (snap, zipper, button, hook & loop, magnet, etc.) also require two hands to open. Moreover, many scarf pockets without closures may tend to bag, sag and gape open, becoming unattractive with use, and not hold items securely, but rather leave pocket contents vulnerable to gravity and/or pickpockets.

[0004] In addition, most scarves with pockets are not reversible, and their usefulness depends upon being worn with their front (or right side) facing outward, and their back (or wrong side) facing the body. Many scarves with discreet pockets are made for women and are advertised as a woman's accessory. Furthermore, some scarves with pockets incorporate plastic which may be uncomfortable to wear and may not be easily washable or dry-cleanable. The prior art in this field includes US20120042432, U.S. Pat. Nos. 9,138,022, 9,138,021, US20170135422. However, none individually or in any combination disclose the features of the present ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0005] Ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets are an improvement over existing pockets with closures as items in an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket may be accessed using only one hand, and this may be either hand.

[0006] Items in the pocket remain secured by the passive restraint system provided by the transformational and synergistic combination of a specific style of keyhole adjoined with a specific type of pocket, in a specific manner. Keyhole-access provides passive restraint for items in the adjoining pocket, as items must both rise up above the mouth of the pocket and make a 90-degree turn to exit the pocket through the attached keyhole.

[0007] As compared with a typical open pocket on a scarf, the form and function of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket deter would-be pickpockets and also reduce the likelihood of items falling out due to gravity.

[0008] The ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket is reversible, and its first embodiments are as an integral part of a reversible scarf. Reversible garments and accessories are preferred by people who are blind and/or have low vision, as they can don reversible items confidently and with ease.

[0009] Ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket scarves are unisex, and can be advertised as fashionable and practical for both men and women.

[0010] The construction of ambidextrous keyhole-access scarves uses soft materials and fibers which may be easily laundered (or depending upon choice of materials, may be dry-cleaned).

[0011] These and other aspects and features of the present disclosure will become more readily apparent upon reading the following detailed description and accompanying changes.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0012] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a scarf embodiment of the present disclosure in a worn configuration.

[0013] FIG. 2 is plan view of the scarf of FIG. 1 and depicted in an unassembled state.

[0014] FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view of FIG. 2 taken along line 3-3 of FIG. 2.

[0015] FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the scarf and depicted in an initial position on a representative user.

[0016] FIG. 5 is a perspective view of the scarf and depicted in an intermediate position.

[0017] FIG. 6 is a perspective view of the scarf and depicted in a final position.

[0018] FIG. 7 is a perspective view of an alternative scarf embodiment with multiple pockets.

[0019] FIG. 8 is a perspective view of a shawl embodiment.

[0020] FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a hat embodiment.

[0021] FIG. 10 is a perspective view of a purse embodiment.

[0022] FIG. 11 is a perspective view of an eyeglasses case embodiment.

[0023] FIG. 12 is a perspective view of an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket attached to an inner shoulder seam of a garment (such as a shirt or blouse, vest, jacket, or coat).

[0024] FIG. 13 is a perspective view of a towel embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0025] Referring to the drawings, and with specific reference to FIG. 1, a scarf constructed in accordance with the present disclosure is generally designated by reference numeral **100**. While the first embodiment is referred to and depicted as a scarf, it is to be understood that the teachings of the present disclosure can be used to construct many other items having an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket including but not limited to shawls, hats, garments, towels, eyeglass cases, purses and the like.

[0026] With reference to FIGS. 1-3, the scarf **100** depicts an embodiment of the present disclosure. The scarf is shown to include a length of fabric forming a body **104**. The body **104** has a first end **112** and a second end **114**. Proximate the first end **112** is an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120** or keyhole-pocket assembly, comprising a pocket **130**, with a keyhole structure **140** being provided thereabove. The pocket **130** comprises a first side **134** and second side **136**, connected at three edges: the first and second side edges **137**, **138**, and the lower edge **139**. The lower edge **139** of the pocket **130** may coincide with the first end **112** of the scarf embodiment **100**, or may be located a distance from the first end **112**, with a length of the scarf body **104** between the first end **112** and the lower edge of the pocket **139**. The keyhole structure **140** comprises a first side **142** and second side **144**, the upper edge of these two sides being connected **146** to each other; the side edges **148**, **149** of the keyhole structure being open. The bottom edge of the first side **142** of the keyhole structure **140** is connected to the upper edge of the first side **134** of the pocket **130**; the bottom edge of the second side **144** of the keyhole structure **140** is connected to the upper edge of the second side **136** of the pocket **130**, thereby forming the pocket opening **132**. The keyhole opening **145** is a tunnel-like pass-through sandwiched between the first and second sides **142**, **144** of the keyhole structure **140**. The width of the keyhole opening **145** extends the width of the keyhole structure's first **142** and second **144** sides, from the first side edge opening **148** to the second side edge opening **149**. The height of the keyhole opening matches the height of the first and second sides **142**, **144** and the first and second side edge openings **148**, **149**.

[0027] With reference to FIGS. 4-6, the scarf **100** is depicted in various states of assembly on a user

402. Turning attention to FIG. 4, the body **104** is shown draped around the shoulders of the user **402**. As depicted, the first end **112** and second end **114** extend roughly equidistant over the chest of user **402**, but this is not essential. As depicted, the first end **112** is on the right hand side of user **402** and the second end **114** is on the left hand side of user **402**, however this could be reversed. The configuration depicted in FIG. 4, and its reversal or mirror image, are referred to herein as the initial worn position.

[0028] Once the scarf **100** is in the initial worn position, the user inserts the second end **114** through the keyhole opening **145**, via keyhole side edge **149**, as indicated in FIG. 5. As the keyhole opening **145** can be accessed through either keyhole side edge **148**, **149**, depending on the handedness of the user, when worn reversed with the first end **112** on the left hand side of the user **402**, the second end **114** is inserted through the keyhole opening **145** via keyhole side edge **148**. The configuration shown and its reversal or mirror image are the intermediate position.

[0029] Upon completing the insertion, the scarf **100** will attain the final worn position shown in FIG. 6. As depicted, the second end **114** is fully extended through the keyhole opening **145** in the worn position. The scarf **100** is secured around the user **402** and the pocket **130** can be accessed through keyhole **145** from either side edge opening **148** or **149** using either hand of the user **402**. To do so, the hand of the user **402** is extended first through the keyhole **145** and the into pocket **130** through opening **132**.

[0030] Although the foregoing embodiment refers to and depicts a scarf with a single ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120**, it is to be understood that the teachings of this disclosure include other scarf embodiments as well as other apparatus embodying ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets. FIGS. 7-13 are examples of such embodiments but are by no means exhaustive.

[0031] Referring now to FIG. 7, an alternative scarf **700** is depicted. As will be noted the scarf **700** is similar to scarf **100** in many respects but now includes a second ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **720** or keyhole-pocket assembly, comprising the second pocket **730** and second keyhole structure **740**, in addition to a first ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120** comprising the pocket **130** and keyhole structure **140**. The second pocket **730** comprises a pocket opening **732**, first side **734**, second side **736**, with the first and second sides connected at the side edges **737**, **738** and lower edge **739**. The second keyhole structure **740** comprises a first side **742** and second side **744**, the upper edge of these two sides being connected **746** to each other; the side edges **748**, **749** of the keyhole structure being open; the bottom edge of the first side **742** of the keyhole structure **740** being connected to the upper edge of the first side **734** of the pocket **130**; and the bottom edge of the second side **744** of the keyhole structure **740** being connected to the upper edge of the second side **736** of the pocket **730**, thereby forming the pocket opening **732**. The keyhole opening **745** is a tunnel-like pass-through sandwiched between the first side and second sides **742**, **744** of the keyhole structure **740**. The width of the keyhole opening **745** extends the width of the keyhole structure first side **742** and second side **744**, from the first side edge opening **748** to the second side edge opening **749**. The height of the keyhole opening matches the height of the first and second sides **742**, **744** and the first and second side edge openings **748**, **749**. To fasten the scarf and attain the final worn position, either first end **112** can be inserted through second keyhole opening **745** (via side edge opening **748** or **749**), or second end **114** can be inserted through first keyhole opening **145** (via side edge opening **148** or **149**). Other embodiments could include even more pockets and keyholes.

[0032] Aside from scarves, many other items can be constructed with ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets. For example, FIG. 8 depicts a shawl **800** embodiment. The shawl **800** is largely the same as the scarf **700** but includes a broadened back panel **810** to cover the back of a user (not shown). First and second keyhole-pocket assemblies **120**, **720** are provided, comprising first and second pockets **130** and **730**, and first and second keyholes **140** and **740**.

[0033] As seen in FIG. 9, a hat **900** can also be constructed using the teachings of the present invention with first and/or second ear flaps, **910** and **920**, respectively, each being formed by an

ambidextrous keyhole-pocket assemblies **120** and **720**. An optional strap **930** is a decorative element extending from the lower edge of the ear flap.

[0034] FIG. **10** depicts a purse embodiment. As shown, the purse **1000** comprises an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120** and a conventional strap **1010**. The strap **1010** is connected where the pocket opening **132** meets the pocket side edges **137**, **138**. Gravity allows the keyhole structure **140** to fold over the pocket **130**.

[0035] Similarly, the teaching of this disclosure can be used to construct a storage case such as the eyeglasses case **1100** depicted at FIG. **11**. The eyeglass case **1100** comprises an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120**, comprising a pocket **130**, and a keyhole structure **140**, with all their aforementioned components and features. Storage cases for items other than eyeglasses are certainly possible.

[0036] Similarly, in FIGS. **12** and **13** a garment **1200** and a towel **1300** are each depicted with an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket **120**, formed therein. The garment embodiment **1200** has a keyhole-pocket assembly **120** attached to an internal shoulder seam of the garment at the upper edge **146** of the keyhole **140** where the first and second sides **142**, **144** (not shown) of the keyhole **140** are connected **146** to each other. The towel embodiment **1300** has a body **1304** attached to the upper edge **146** of the keyhole **140** where the first and second sides **142**, **144** (not shown) of the keyhole **140** are connected **146** to each other.

Scarf Embodiment Details

[0037] The first embodiments of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets are adjustable, reversible unisex neckwarmer scarves or mufflers with reversible ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets. When worn open, a minimalist, streamlined unisex scarf with one or more ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets appears at first glance to be a plain ordinary straight scarf, with a fairly uniform width.

[0038] The placement of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket(s) in a scarf embodiment may be at the lower edge of the scarf end(s) or at a distance up from the end(s) of the scarf, with optional scarf body below the pocket(s).

[0039] The location of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket(s) in a scarf embodiment, relative to the wearer's body, may be considered chest/breast pockets and/or waist/hip pockets. This may vary depending upon the size of the scarf and how the scarf is worn. See "States of the scarf embodiment."

[0040] The noticeability of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket(s) may be attention-getting or concealed/discreet and these differences may be accomplished using any combination of materials, surface textures, colors, and construction methods which may highlight or obscure the perception of scarf thickness and/or the various components of the embodiment, keyhole, and pocket.

Ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets are versatile: the pocket can be secret, hidden in plain view, nearly unnoticeable-OR-can be a conversation piece and featured focal point of the embodiment. Some examples to leverage the utility of ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets for a wide variety of uses: smooth or textured materials (such as fur, polar fleece; fuzzy, eyelash, or roving yarn(s); and light or heavyweight fabric(s)), solid or patterned materials (such as tweed or printed yarn(s); tweed or houndstooth fabric(s), color combinations (such as solid, stripes, prints, ombre, school colors, flag colors, or team colors), construction methods (same or varied throughout the scarf, highlighting or obscuring the keyhole(s) and pocket(s)).

[0041] The utility of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket and the articles into which it is incorporated may be enhanced by creating each article with or without embellishment, adornment, surface decoration and/or ornamentation, including but not limited to: lightweight fabrics for warm seasons or warm weather climates, additional width of the scarf body providing the wearer with extra coverage and warmth in cold weather, shaped pockets, shaped keyholes, shaped scarves, knit and/or crochet stitch textures, including basket weave, checkerboard, Aran, Irish, cables, eyelet, granny square, and/or lace, intarsia or colorwork, Nordic and/or Fair Isle, quilting, nature themes

including animal faces and/or bodies, seasonal themes, motifs, numbers, symbols, letters, initials, monograms, embroidery, beads, high visibility colors such as neon bright and/or light reflective materials, monochromatic or contrasting color-blocking and/or stripes of various widths, school colors, flag colors, team colors, or any other.

[0042] The size of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket and the articles into which it is incorporated may be any size. Whether someone is petite or tall, slim or zaftig, an ambidextrous keyhole-access scarf may be right-sized for them.

[0043] A minimalist scarf may have a width of approximately 4-6 inches, length approximately 3-4 feet, and neck wrap approximately 16-24 inches for an adult.

[0044] When constructed by knitting, the scarf embodiment may be scaled up by using larger yarn and needles, casting on more stitches for a wider scarf, knitting additional rows for more length, and/or adding more ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets.

[0045] When constructed by knitting, a scarf embodiment may be scaled down by using smaller yarn and needles, casting on fewer stitches for a narrow scarf, knitting fewer rows for a shorter scarf, and/or creating a scarf with just one ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket. Tiny ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket scarves, sized for a doll or Teddy Bear, have also been made.

States of the Scarf Embodiment

[0046] The scarf may be worn open (FIG. 4) with the center of the length of the scarf substantially near the center back of the wearer's neck, and the length of each half of the scarf draped forward over the corresponding shoulder and hanging in front of the wearer. When worn open, the minimalist, streamlined unisex scarf with one ambidextrous keyhole access pocket appears at first glance to be a plain ordinary straight scarf, with a fairly uniform width.

[0047] The scarf may be worn closed (FIG. 6) with the center of the length of the scarf substantially near the center back of the wearer's neck, and the length of each half of the scarf draped forward over the corresponding shoulder and one end of the scarf crossing in front of the wearer and tucked through the keyhole, with the length adjusted to fit comfortably on the wearer.

[0048] The scarf may be worn wrapped around the neck, fully encircling the neck, and open or closed in front. (Not pictured.)

[0049] A scarf embodiment with one ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket and ending in a second keyhole (not pictured) would generally be worn closed, with the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket passing through the second keyhole and the two keyholes aligned, one inside the other.

Glossary of Terms

[0050] Ambidextrous—equally accessible to either hand, with the choice of hand used depending upon the handedness of the user. [0051] Ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket—the present disclosure. An apparatus comprising a specific type of keyhole adjoined with a specific type of pocket, in a specific manner, as revealed. Keyhole-pocket assembly. [0052] Back—the second side, or “wrong side” (WS). In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation may be arbitrary, but serves to indicate there is more than one side. [0053] Bottom—lower edge. Orientation is relative to usual position for utilizing or wearing apparatus or embodiment, regardless of the direction of the item as illustrated on any page of drawings in this application. [0054] Closed—state of scarf or shawl embodiment being worn encircling the neck or around the back of the neck and draped over the shoulders and secured in front of the wearer by means of scarf or shawl end inserted through keyhole. Also described as the final worn position. [0055] Final worn position—state of scarf or shawl embodiment being worn encircling the neck or around the back of the neck and draped over the shoulders and secured in front of the wearer by means of scarf or shawl end inserted through keyhole. Also described as “closed.” [0056] Front—the first side, or “right side” (RS). In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation may be arbitrary, but serves to indicate there is more than one side. [0057] Initial worn position—state of scarf or shawl embodiment being worn encircling the neck or around the back of the neck and draped over the shoulders with the ends substantially in front of the wearer's chest. Scarf or shawl end is not inserted through keyhole. Also

described as “open.” [0058] Items—objects deposited or placed in a pocket, stored, carried, held in the pocket, or removed from the pocket. The term “items” may also refer to articles embodying ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets. [0059] Keyhole—the hole or opening or pass-through used to fasten the scarf or shawl, and/or to access the pocket. See “Keyhole opening.” The term “keyhole” may also refer to the structure comprising components which together form the described hole or opening; the keyhole structure. See “Keyhole structure.” [0060] Keyhole first side or front side—one of two faces, walls, or flaps between which the keyhole opening is sandwiched. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “front” and “back” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. A component of the Keyhole structure. [0061] Keyhole first side edge opening—one of two slits, ports, portals, which are access points to the keyhole opening. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation “left” and “right” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0062] Keyhole opening—the hole or tunnel-like pass-through used to fasten the scarf or shawl, and/or to access the pocket (to place items in the pocket, and to retrieve items from the pocket). The keyhole opening is an interior space having substantially fixed characteristics of height and width, while the depth varies during use. The height of the keyhole opening is the height of the keyhole first side, keyhole second side, keyhole first side edge opening, keyhole second side edge opening. The width of the keyhole opening extends from the keyhole first side edge opening to the keyhole second side edge opening, and is the width of the keyhole first side or the keyhole second side. [0063] Keyhole-pocket assembly—the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket disclosed herein. An apparatus comprising a specific type of keyhole adjoined with a specific type of pocket, in a specific manner, as described. [0064] Keyhole second side or back side—one of two faces, walls, or flaps between which the keyhole opening is sandwiched. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “front” and “back” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. A component of the Keyhole structure. [0065] Keyhole second side edge opening—one of two slits, ports, portals, which are access points to the keyhole opening. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation “left” and “right” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0066] Keyhole structure—comprising a first side or front side, second side or back side, the connection of these two sides at their upper edge, and having left and right side edge openings, and an open bottom synonymous with the opening at the top of the pocket. Together, these components form, surround, and define an interior space which is the keyhole opening. [0067] Keyhole top edge seam—designates the line at which the first side of the keyhole meets the second side of the keyhole along the upper edge shared in common, whether there is a traditional seam present or not. The top edge seam of the keyhole may be attached to a scarf, shawl, hat, garment, towel, or other embodiment or it may not be attached to anything (eyeglasses case and purse are examples of this). [0068] Mirror image—illustration flipped or rotated to reverse right and left, as though seen reflected in a looking glass or mirror. In a reversible article or embodiment, this serves to indicate that left and right are interchangeable. [0069] Mouth of pocket—opening at top of pocket. Upper edge of pocket. Pocket opening. [0070] Neckwrap—a length of the body of a scarf embodiment, which is intended to encircle a wearer's neck or cover the back of a wearer's neck. For example: in a scarf with two ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets, the neck wrap is the center distance between the two keyholes. [0071] Open—state of scarf or shawl embodiment being worn encircling the neck or around the back of the neck and draped over the shoulders with the ends substantially in front of the wearer's chest. Scarf or shawl end is not inserted through keyhole. Also described as the initial worn position. [0072] Pocket—the interior space which may hold, carry, cradle, or store items. The term “pocket” may also refer to the structure or components forming the described interior space. [0073] Pocket bottom or pocket bottom edge seam—designates the line at which the first side of the pocket is connected or joined with the second side of the pocket along the lower edge shared in common, whether there is a traditional seam present or not. The pocket bottom may be located at the end of an embodiment, or located some length above the end of the

embodiment. [0074] Pocket first side or front side—one of two faces or walls, between which the pocket interior space is sandwiched. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “front” and “back” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0075] Pocket first side edge seam—designates the line at which the first side of the pocket meets the second side of the pocket along a right or left vertical edge shared in common, whether there is a traditional seam present or not. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “left” and “right” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0076] Pocket opening—the top or upper edge of the pocket, connected to and synonymous with the bottom of the keyhole. [0077] Pocket second side or back side—one of two faces or walls, between which the pocket interior space is sandwiched. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “front” and “back” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0078] Pocket second side edge seam—designates the line at which the first side of the pocket meets the second side of the pocket along a right or left vertical edge shared in common, whether there is a traditional seam present or not. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “left” and “right” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used. [0079] Right Side—(RS), the first side or front side, as opposed to the Wrong Side (WS), second side, or back side. The “right side” edge may also be opposite the “left side” edge. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation may be arbitrary, but serves to indicate there is more than one side. [0080] Seam—a connection or joining, regardless of whether a traditional fiber arts seam is present. [0081] Side—a face or wall or flap component lying substantially in a plane. The term “side” may also refer to front/back. The term “side” may also refer to an edge on the right or left. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designations “front” and “back” and “left” and “right” may be arbitrary, therefore the terms first and second may be used, i.e. “first side,” “first side edge,” “second side,” “second side edge.” [0082] Tail—part of a scarf body, particularly the area proximate an end of a scarf. The term “tail” may refer to the second end of a scarf, opposite the keyhole-pocket assembly. The term “tail” may refer to either end of a scarf. [0083] Top—upper edge. Orientation is relative to usual position for utilizing or wearing apparatus or embodiment, regardless of the direction of the item as illustrated on any page of drawings in this application. [0084] Tuck—to insert the end of a scarf or shawl embodiment into and through the keyhole. The term “tuck” can also refer to a portion of the scarf or shawl body which is inside the keyhole when the scarf or shawl is worn in a closed state. [0085] User—person utilizing, wearing, or interacting with the described article or embodiment. [0086] Wearer—person using or wearing the described article or embodiment; user. [0087] Wrong Side—(WS), the second side or back side, as opposed to the Right Side (RS), first side, or front side. In a reversible article or embodiment, the designation may be arbitrary, but serves to indicate there is more than one side.

Need for the Invention

[0088] The utility of many pockets is limited because they can be accessed by only one hand or the other.

[0089] Many pockets with closures (snap, zipper, button, hook & loop, magnet, etc.) require two hands to open.

[0090] Many pockets without closures may tend to bag, sag and gape open, becoming unattractive with use, and not holding items securely, but rather leaving pocket contents vulnerable to gravity and/or pickpockets.

[0091] Most scarves with pockets are not reversible, and their usefulness depends upon being worn with their front (or right side) facing outward, and their back (or wrong side) facing the body.

[0092] Many scarves with discreet pockets are made for women and are advertised as a woman's accessory.

[0093] Some scarves with pockets incorporate plastic which may be uncomfortable to wear and may not be easily washable or dry-cleanable.

Needs Met by the Invention

[0094] Ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets are an improvement over existing pockets with closures as items in an ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket may be accessed with one hand, and this may be either hand.

[0095] Items in the pocket remain secured by the passive restraint system provided by the transformational and synergistic combination of a specific style of keyhole adjoined with a specific type of pocket, in a specific manner. Keyhole-access provides passive restraint for items in the adjoining pocket, as items must both rise up above the mouth of the pocket and make a 90-degree turn to exit the pocket through the attached keyhole.

[0096] As compared with a typical open pocket on a scarf, the form and function of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket deter would-be pickpockets and also reduce the likelihood of items falling out due to gravity.

[0097] The ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket is reversible, and its first embodiments are as an integral part of reversible scarves. I'm told that such reversible garments and accessories are preferred by people who are blind and/or have low vision, as they can don reversible items confidently and with ease.

[0098] Ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket scarves are unisex, and can be advertised as fashionable and practical for both men and women.

[0099] The construction of ambidextrous keyhole-access scarves uses soft materials and fibers which may be easily laundered (or depending upon choice of materials, may be dry-cleaned).

[0100] The ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket scarf may be any size. Whether someone is petite or tall, slim or zaftig, an ambidextrous keyhole-access scarf may be right-sized for them.

Description of Methods

Method of Use

[0101] The use of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket, embodied in a scarf has a similarity to any other keyhole scarf: just pass the tail end of the scarf through the keyhole to fasten the scarf securely in place. But, unlike any other keyhole scarf known, a user can reach into the keyhole to access the integral pocket.

[0102] The wearer may access the contents of their ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket(s), through either side edge opening of the keyhole, whether the scarf is worn open or closed.

[0103] Reversible garments and accessories may be preferred by people who are blind and/or have low vision, as they can don reversible items confidently and with ease.

[0104] Whether a person may be facing a weather-related emergency, going about everyday activities such as walking the dog or running errands, or attending a fundraising gala and wanting to have tip money readily available for the valet parking attendant, an extra pocket or a plurality of pockets offering both security and easy access is a welcome amenity. Depending upon the adventure you are embarking on, the reversible, ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket will carry your small, lightweight essentials such as lip balm, travel size sunscreen, a small pack of facial tissues, ID, credit card, chewing gum, flash drive, grocery store list, money, business cards, or sunglasses, etc.

[0105] The scarf or other embodiment may be used as gift-wrapping, to give a small greeting or gift placed in one or more of its ambidextrous keyhole-access pockets.

[0106] Items are held, carried, and stored discreetly provided that the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket is not overstuffed.

[0107] To prevent stretching or creasing, the scarf embodiment can be jelly rolled for storage.

Construction Methods

[0108] The ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket and the articles into which it is incorporated may be created by hand or machine knitting, sewing, crochet, macrame, weaving, quilting, or any combination of fiber arts.

[0109] The ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket scarf embodiment may be any size. While the first embodiment was created by knitting, and sizing is described in terms of knitting in the majority of

this document, the principle of flexible sizing also applies to other methods of construction, such as sewing for example.

[0110] The minimalist, hand-knit version of the reversible scarf with one reversible ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket can be created in one piece without seams, working from end to end, up one side and down the other. Pockets are knit in the round using Magic Loop method on circular needles (or using a double knitting technique if you prefer), while the rest of the scarf, including the keyholes, are knit flat. When knitting, this scarf begins with casting on the closed bottom of the pocket and working upward in the round, like a toe-up sock. Above the pocket is the keyhole. Continuing upward is the body of the scarf, which may be any length desired. When creating a plurality of pockets, or in deference to maker preference, construction method may alternate from bottom-up to top-down pocket construction.

[0111] The shape of the keyhole(s) may be square, rectangular, or shaped by various means such as cinching, or short rows. (See FIG. 9 which is illustrative not exhaustive.) method may alternate from bottom-up to top-down pocket construction.

[0112] Each side or flap or face of the keyhole may be constructed from a single piece or from multiple components such as: layering various shapes, positioning individual linear components horizontally and/or vertically and/or diagonally to form each flap of the keyhole. The keyhole flaps may be identical to each other or dissimilar thereby one embodiment may provide multiple “looks.” The keyhole(s) and/or individual keyhole flap(s) may be lined or unlined.

[0113] The characteristics and shape of the ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket(s) may vary, adapting the form and function to carry, cradle, and hold different items. (See FIGS. 9, 12 which are illustrative, not exhaustive.) The characteristics of the pockets, may be any combination of: lined or unlined; divided or single compartment; shapes such as: semi-circle, oval, square, with corners being angular or rounded off; rectangular, with corners being angular or rounded off; triangular, (wider mouth tapered to point bottom-or-narrow mouth flared to wider bottom) with corners being angular or rounded off; novelty shapes such as socks, stockings, mittens, puppets.

LIST OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

[0114] **100**—scarf embodiment [0115] **104**—body of scarf embodiment [0116] **112**—first end of scarf embodiment [0117] **114**—second end of scarf embodiment [0118] **120**—ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket; keyhole-pocket assembly. Comprising **130** and **140**. [0119] **130**—pocket. Comprising **132**, **134**, **136**, **137**, **138**, **139**. [0120] **132**—pocket opening [0121] **134**—pocket first side [0122] **136**—pocket second side [0123] **137**—pocket first side edge seam [0124] **138**—pocket second side edge seam [0125] **139**—pocket bottom edge seam [0126] **140**—keyhole assembly. Comprising **142**, **144**, **145**, **146**, **148**, **149**. [0127] **142**—keyhole first side [0128] **144**—keyhole second side [0129] **145**—keyhole opening or pass-through [0130] **146**—seam, join, or connection at upper edge of **142** & **144** [0131] **148**—keyhole first side edge opening [0132] **149**—keyhole second side edge opening [0133] **402**—user or wearer of embodiment [0134] **700**—scarf embodiment having multiple pockets [0135] **704**—body of scarf embodiment having multiple pockets [0136] **720**—second ambidextrous keyhole-access pocket; keyhole-pocket assembly. Comprising **730** and **740**. [0137] **730**—second pocket. Comprising **732**, **734**, **736**, **737**, **738**, **739**. [0138] **732**—opening of second pocket [0139] **734**—first side of second pocket [0140] **736**—second side of second pocket [0141] **737**—first side edge seam of second pocket [0142] **738**—second side edge seam of second pocket [0143] **739**—bottom edge seam of second pocket [0144] **740**—second keyhole assembly. Comprising **742**, **744**, **745**, **746**, **748**, **749**. [0145] **742**—first side of second keyhole [0146] **744**—second side of second keyhole [0147] **745**—opening or pass-through of second keyhole [0148] **746**—seam, join, or connection at upper edge of **742** & **744** [0149] **748**—first side edge opening of second keyhole [0150] **749**—second side edge opening of second keyhole [0151] **800**—shawl embodiment [0152] **804**—body of shawl embodiment [0153] **810**—broadened back panel [0154] **900**—hat embodiment [0155] **910**—first ear flap. Comprising **120**. [0156] **920**—second ear flap. Comprising **720**. [0157] **930**—optional decorative element of

ear flap [0158] **1000**—purse embodiment [0159] **1010**—purse strap [0160] **1100**—storage case embodiment; eyeglasses case embodiment [0161] **1200**—garment embodiment [0162] **1204**—body of garment embodiment [0163] **1300**—towel embodiment [0164] **1304**—body of towel embodiment

Claims

1. A scarf, comprising: a length of fabric having first and second ends, the length of fabric defining a longitudinal axis; a pocket provided proximate the first end, the pocket including front and back sides closed along left, right and bottom edges, the pocket including an opening along a top edge of the pocket with the top edge being perpendicular to the longitudinal axis of the scarf; a keyhole provided immediately above the pocket, the keyhole being defined by front and back flaps connected along a keyhole top edge, the keyhole top edge being parallel to the pocket top edge, the front and back flap being open along left and right edges defining a keyhole opening, the bottom of the keyhole flaps being connected to and synonymous with the pocket top edge, forming the pocket opening, the second end of the scarf being adapted to be inserted through one of the keyhole opening left and right edges and out the other of the keyhole opening left and right edges, and the pocket being adapted to be accessed through the keyhole opening and pocket opening, the keyhole and pocket forming one contiguous open space.
 2. The scarf of claim 1, wherein the pocket can be accessed using only one hand of a user.
 3. The scarf of claim 1, wherein the pocket can be accessed by either hand of the user.
 4. The scarf of claim 1, wherein the scarf is reversible.
 5. The scarf of claim 1, further including more than one keyhole-pocket assembly.
 6. A fabric apparatus, comprising: a pocket having first and second sides, a bottom edge, two side edges, and an open top extending in a first direction; and a keyhole access port positioned proximate the open top; the keyhole access port having first and second sides a closed top, two open side edges, and an open bottom communicating with the open top of the pocket, the keyhole access port and pocket forming one contiguous open space.
 7. The fabric apparatus of claim 6, wherein the apparatus is one of a scarf, shawl, hat, purse, eyeglasses case, garment, and towel.
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